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To the Hiring Manager,

My name is Maya Winland-Gaetz, and I am a third-year Electrical Engineering student and Canadian citizen seeking my first co-op term in as the Electrical Engineering Co-op Student at Reliable Controls, available for 8 months. As a mature student who previously studied at the graduate level in aquatic geochemistry, I returned to university to pursue my passion for electronic design, and I believe ;THIS NEEDS WORK;, my qualifications both old and new would make me an ideal fit for this role.

My most recent co-op work experience at Ocean Networks Canada served as an excellent opportunity and proving-ground for greatly expanding my range of electrical design skills. - PyQt to design a UI for configuring connections using a variety of industrial protocols (RS-485 and MQTT primarily), and others were more back-end focused, using SQLite to efficiently manage a database of the collected telemetry. With my final project, I exceeded expectations by reverse-engineering the command structure of an Alcatel 1626LM fiber-optic node around a day after it was assigned to me, to the surprise of my supervisor!

Although my academic performance is very strong, my study of electronics is a central feature of my life. I joined the UVic Satellite Design Club as a highly active member, and have assumed responsibility for the radio-communications systems. I designed two evaluation boards for the TI CC1201 transceiver SoC and a matched power amplifier, have just completed hand-assembling them using hot air rework and a soldering iron, and am currently engaged in developing a testing and verification plan. Besides these, I spend much of my free time on personal electronics projects, the most current among which is designing and programming a waveform generator to serve my long-term goal of constructing a hybrid analog-digital music synthesizer. I find it easy to self-motivate when the work is its own reward.

I would be thrilled to have the opportunity to interview with you, and yet more thrilled still to be able to work at Ocean Networks Canada! Although I left my previous career in environmental science, I still strongly believe in the values that led me to seek it in the first place: using sustainable technology and industry to leave the world a better place than we found it. I believe there is much I can bring to the table, be it from my previous career or my current drive to learn and achieve more in the field of electrical engineering.

If you are interested, I can be best reached over email, but I am also available via phone if that would work better for you. Thank you for taking the time to read my letter, and for your consideration.

I look forward to hearing from you!
Sincerely,

Maya Winland-Gaetz